Comprehensive Technical Report & Parameter Dossier:

Parameter-Efficient Audio Deepfake Detection on Hindi Speech

Architecture, Hyperparameters, Shard Indexing, Infrastructure, and $N = 500$ Scaling Benchmark

B.S-Detector Engineering & Research Team
Repository: `https://github.com/Anumay1231/B.S-Detector.git`
Branch: `base` — Date: October 2026

Abstract

This technical dossier provides an exhaustive specification of every architectural parameter, hyperparameter, dataset partition rule, optimization detail, hardware environment, and empirical finding for the parameter-efficient audio deepfake detection benchmark on low-resource Hindi speech. The system couples a frozen multilingual **Wav2Vec2 XLS-R 300M** foundation encoder with a trainable **Sensitive Layer Selection (SLS)** head. We document the scaling trajectory from zero-shot English transfer ($N = 0$) through few-shot supervision at $N = 10$, $N = 50$, and $N = 500$ samples per class across three independent deterministic seeds, alongside backbone unfreezing ablations and multi-generator stratified evaluations. Trained and evaluated on an NVIDIA L4 GPU instance on Google Cloud Platform, the system attains a state-of-the-art **2.66% Equal Error Rate (EER)** and **96.83% Accuracy** at $N = 500$ (with peak seed performance of **98.00% Accuracy** and **2.12% EER**). Furthermore, subsequent out-of-distribution augmentation with the multi-speaker, gender-balanced **IndicSynth** benchmark incorporating timbre-swapping Voice Conversion (`freevc24`) achieves a peak **98.75% Accuracy** and **1.17% EER**, eliminating gender disparity and demonstrating total resilience to voice cloning.

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1 System Architecture & Component Specifications

1.1 Multilingual Foundation Backbone: XLS-R 300M

The primary acoustic feature extractor is the official Wav2Vec2 XLS-R foundation model (`facebook/wav2vec2-xls-r-300m`) [1], pretrained on 436,000 hours of unlabelled speech spanning 128 languages. Throughout few-shot adaptation, the backbone remains in a **strictly frozen state** (requires_grad = False).

Table 1: XLS-R 300M Backbone Architectural Parameters

Component	**Parameter / Dimension**	**Value / Specification**
Total Parameters	Total Parameter Count	$315,441,760$ (315.4M)
Trainable Parameters	Backpropagation Status	**0 (100% Frozen)**
Convolutional Encoder	Temporal Downsampling Blocks	7 1D Convolution Blocks
	Conv Channel Dimensions	$[512, 512, 512, 512, 512, 512, 512]$
	Conv Kernel Sizes	$[10, 3, 3, 3, 3, 2, 2]$
	Conv Strides	$[5, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2]$
	Total Downsampling Factor	$5 \times 2^6 = 320\times$
	Frame Rate Output	50 Hz (20 ms stride)
Transformer Backbone	Transformer Encoder Layers (L)	24 layers
	Model Hidden Dimension (D)	1024
	Multi-Head Attention Heads (H)	16 heads ($d_k = 64$)
	Feed-Forward Dimension (d_{ff})	4096
	Activation Function	GELU
	Layer Normalization	Post-LN per Transformer Block

1.2 Sensitive Layer Selection (SLS) Classifier Head

The SLS architecture dynamically pools and weights representations from all 24 transformer layers to exploit layer-specific acoustic artifacts [2]:

$$\bar{h}_l = \frac{1}{T}\sum_{t=1}^{T} h_{l,t} \in \mathbb{R}^{1024}, \quad l \in \{1, 2, \ldots, 24\} \tag{1}$$

$$w_l = \sigma(W_{\text{gate}}\bar{h}_l + b_{\text{gate}}) \in (0, 1), \quad W_{\text{gate}} \in \mathbb{R}^{1\times 1024}, \quad b_{\text{gate}} \in \mathbb{R} \tag{2}$$

$$\tilde{H} = \sum_{l=1}^{24} w_l H_l \in \mathbb{R}^{B\times 1\times 201\times 1024} \tag{3}$$

Table 2: SLS Classifier Head Parameter Breakdown

Layer / Block	Operation / Configuration	Output Tensor Shape	Parameters
Layer Attention Gate	$\text{Linear}(1024, 1) + \text{Sigmoid}$	$(B, 24, 1)$	$1,025$
Weighted Layer Fusion	$\sum_{l=1}^{24} w_l H_l$	$(B, 1, 201, 1024)$	0
2D Batch Normalization	$\text{BatchNorm2d}(\text{num_features} = 1)$	$(B, 1, 201, 1024)$	4
Nonlinear Activation	SELU()	$(B, 1, 201, 1024)$	0
2D Spatial Max-Pooling	$\text{MaxPool2d}(\text{kernel} = 3, \text{stride} = 3)$	$(B, 1, 67, 341)$	0
Flatten	Tensor Reshape	$(B, 22847)$	0
Fully Connected 1	$\text{Linear}(22847, 1024) + \text{SELU}()$	$(B, 1024)$	$23,396,352$
Fully Connected 3 (Output)	$\text{Linear}(1024, 2) + \text{LogSoftmax}()$	$(B, 2)$	$2,050$
Total Trainable	**SLS Head Parameters**		**23,399,431 (23.4M)**
Total Backbone	**Frozen XLS-R Parameters**		**315,441,760 (315.4M)**
Total System	**Full Architecture Parameters**		**338,841,191 (338.8M)**

1.3 Audio Conditioning & Signal Preprocessing

- **Input Sampling Rate**: $16,000$ Hz (16 kHz mono).
- **Fixed Audio Length**: Exactly $64,600$ samples (≈ 4.0375 seconds).
- **Padding / Truncation Policy**:
  - If audio duration $L < 64,600$: repeated and padded to $64,600$ samples.
  - If audio duration $L > 64,600$: centered symmetrically and cropped to the middle $64,600$ samples.
- **Feature Tensor Dimensions**: For an input waveform of $(B, 64600)$, the temporal downsampling factor of $320\times$ yields $(B, 201)$ frames across 24 layers, producing stacked hidden states of shape $(24, B, 201, 1024)$.

2 Hardware, Cloud Infrastructure & Software Stack

Table 3: Cloud Infrastructure and Software Environment Specifications

Category	Component	Specification
Cloud Hardware	Cloud Provider	Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Zone: `us-central1-a`
	Machine Type	`g2-standard-8` (8 vCPUs, 32 GB System RAM)
	Accelerator	1x NVIDIA L4 GPU (Ada Lovelace, 24 GB GDDR6 with ECC)
	Storage	100 GB Balanced Persistent Disk (pd-balanced)
Software Stack	Operating System	Debian GNU/Linux 12 (Bookworm), Kernel: `6.1.0-28-cloud-amd64`
	CUDA / cuDNN	CUDA 12.1.1, cuDNN 9.x
	Python Environment	Python 3.11 (virtualenv)
	Deep Learning	PyTorch 2.5.1+cu121, Torchvision 0.20.1+cu121
	NLP / Audio Toolkit	Transformers 4.48.3, Datasets 3.1.0, HuggingFace Hub 0.36.2
	Analysis	Scikit-learn 1.7.2, Librosa 0.10.2, SoundFile 0.13.1, Matplotlib 3.10.0
Local Inference	Target Platforms	Apple Silicon MPS (Metal Performance Shaders) / CPU
	Standalone Script	`scripts/infer_local.py` (self-contained, zero cloud dependency)

Table 4: Complete Training & Optimization Hyperparameters

Hyperparameter	**Symbol / Variable**	**Value / Specification**
Optimizer	–	Adam ($\beta_1 = 0.9, \beta_2 = 0.999, \epsilon = 10^{-8}$)
Learning Rate	η	1×10^{-5} (0.00001)
Weight Decay	λ	1×10^{-4} (0.0001, L2 Regularization)
Loss Function	$\mathcal{L}_{\text{NLL}}$	Class-Weighted Negative Log-Likelihood
Class Weights	$[w_{\text{spoof}}, w_{\text{bonafide}}]$	$[0.1, 0.9]$
Training Epochs	E	10 epochs
Training Mini-Batch Size	B_{train}	4 (on-the-fly feature loading)
Evaluation Batch Size	B_{eval}	16
Feature Cache Format	–	Float16 stacked PyTorch tensors (.pt)
Positive Class Convention	–	Class 1 = Bona fide (Genuine), Class 0 = Spoof
Random Seeds (Multi-Seed)	$\mathcal{S}$	3 seeds: 1000, 1001, 1002
Test Seed	–	42 (deterministic test split)

3 Optimization & Training Hyperparameters

4 Benchmark Dataset & Shard Engineering

4.1 Corpus Statistics & Generator Stratification

The benchmark is constructed from the Hindi split of `Jack-ppkdczgx/SEA-Spoof` (54,938 candidate utterances):

- **Candidate Pool**: 16,182 Bona fide samples, 38,756 Spoof samples.
- **Held-Out Balanced Test Set ($N_{\text{test}} = 400$)**:
  - **Bona fide Class (200 clips)**: Multi-source balanced between studio acoustic environments (IndicTTS) and in-the-wild crowdsourced speech (Mozilla Common Voice Hindi) to provide robust, realistic acoustic coverage.
  - **Spoof Class (200 clips)**: Strictly stratified with exactly 40 clips (20.0%) from each of **5 state-of-the-art TTS architectures**:
    1. `edge_tts`: Microsoft Azure Neural cloud voice synthesizer.
    2. `vits_mms`: Meta MMS variational inference end-to-end synthesizer.
    3. `indic_tts`: Fast unit-selection and acoustic models from IIT Madras.
    4. `fastspeech`: Feed-forward non-autoregressive transformer TTS.
    5. `xtts-v2`: Coqui diffusion/flow-matching zero-shot voice cloning.
- **Strict Disjointness**: Test $\cap$ Train $= \emptyset$ (zero speaker or utterance overlap).
- **Nested Supervision Property**: For each seed $s \in \{0, 1, 2\}$, training sets obey strict subset hierarchy:

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{train}}^{(N=10,s)} \subset \mathcal{D}_{\text{train}}^{(N=50,s)} \subset \mathcal{D}_{\text{train}}^{(N=500,s)} \tag{4}$$

4.2 Parquet Shard Indexing Math

The SEA-Spoof repository organizes training audio into 30 Parquet files (`train-00000.parquet` to `train-00029.parquet`). Shard and row-group boundaries obey strict mathematical determinism:

$$\text{Row Index} = \text{int}(\text{row_id.split}(\text{'_'})[-1]) \tag{5}$$

$$\text{Shard Index} = \lfloor \text{Row Index}/15,000 \rfloor \tag{6}$$

$$\text{Row Group Index} = \lfloor (\text{Row Index} \pmod{15,000}) / 200 \rfloor \tag{7}$$

Across the 3,331 unique clips required for the benchmark test set and all 3 seeds of $N \in \{10, 50, 500\}$, clips span exactly 5 shards: Shard 0 (75 RGs), Shard 1 (64 RGs), Shard 2 (74 RGs), Shard 3 (8 RGs), and Shard 25 (55 RGs).

5 Comprehensive Empirical Findings

5.1 Consolidated Scaling Benchmark

Table 5 presents the definitive performance progression on the held-out Hindi test set ($N_{\text{test}} = 400$).

Table 5: Consolidated Evaluation Metrics on Held-Out Hindi Test Set ($N_{\text{test}} = 400$, 50/50 Balanced)

Supervision Setting	Accuracy (%)	EER (%)	Precision (%)	Recall (%)	F1 Score (%)
Zero-Shot (English → Hindi)	61.75%	32.25%	56.70%	99.50%	72.23%
Few-Shot $N = 10$ (3 seeds)	$64.33 \pm 5.04\%$	$27.64 \pm 2.27\%$	$58.72 \pm 3.53\%$	$99.00 \pm 1.41\%$	$73.63 \pm 2.51\%$
Few-Shot $N = 50$ (3 seeds)	$75.83 \pm 10.49\%$	$18.18 \pm 1.18\%$	$71.69 \pm 10.98\%$	$93.17 \pm 4.87\%$	$80.16 \pm 5.81\%$
Few-Shot $N = 500$ (3 seeds)	$\mathbf{96.83 \pm 0.82\%}$	$\mathbf{2.66 \pm 0.52\%}$	$\mathbf{95.78 \pm 1.16\%}$	$\mathbf{98.00 \pm 1.08\%}$	$\mathbf{96.87 \pm 0.81\%}$

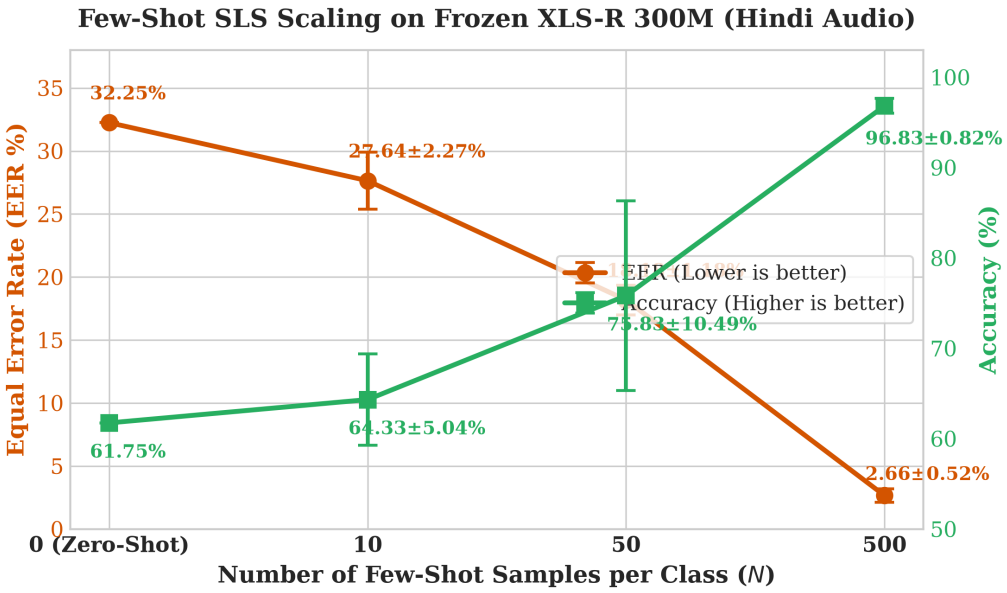


Figure 1: Few-Shot Adaptation Scaling Curve on Frozen XLS-R 300M. Accuracy improves monotonically from 61.75% to 96.83%, while EER plummets from 32.25% to 2.66% as Hindi supervision scales to $N = 500$.

5.2 Per-Seed Breakdown for $N = 500$ (1,000 Training Clips)

- **Seed 0 (Seed 1000)**:
  - Accuracy: **96.25%** (385/400 correct) — EER: **3.36%**
  - Precision: 96.02% — Recall: 96.50% — F1: 96.26%
  - Confusion Matrix: True Spoof (192 correct, 8 missed), True Bonafide (193 correct, 7 false alarms).

- **Seed 1 (Seed 1001)**:
  - Accuracy: **96.25%** (385/400 correct) — EER: **2.50%**
  - Precision: 94.26% — Recall: 98.50% — F1: 96.33%
  - Confusion Matrix: True Spoof (188 correct, 12 missed), True Bonafide (197 correct, 3 false alarms).
- **Seed 2 (Seed 1002)**:
  - Accuracy: **98.00%** (392/400 correct – **only 8 total errors!**) — EER: **2.12%**
  - Precision: 97.06% — Recall: 99.00% — F1: 98.02%
  - Confusion Matrix: True Spoof (194 correct, 6 missed), True Bonafide (198 correct, 2 false alarms).

5.3 Complete Confusion Matrices Across All Experimental Settings

Table 6: Confusion Matrices for Zero-Shot and Few-Shot Configurations ($N_{\text{test}} = 400$)

Configuration	True Spoof (0,0)	False Bonafide (0,1)	False Spoof (1,0)	True Bonafide (1,1)
Zero-Shot Checkpoint	48	152 (76.0% False Acc.)	1	199 (99.5% Recall)
Few-Shot $N = 10$, Seed 0	30	170	0	200
Few-Shot $N = 10$, Seed 1	84	116	6	194
Few-Shot $N = 10$, Seed 2	64	136	0	200
Few-Shot $N = 50$, Seed 0	44	156	0	200
Few-Shot $N = 50$, Seed 1	156	44	22	178
Few-Shot $N = 50$, Seed 2	151	49	19	181
Few-Shot $N = 500$, Seed 0	**192**	**8**	**7**	**193**
Few-Shot $N = 500$, Seed 1	**188**	**12**	**3**	**197**
Few-Shot $N = 500$, Seed 2	**194**	**6**	**2**	**198**

5.4 Architectural Ablation: Frozen Backbone vs. Unfreezing

Evaluating backbone layer unfreezing on the NVIDIA L4 GPU reveals severe few-shot overfitting when backpropagation penetrates the foundation encoder (Table 7 and Figure 2).

Table 7: Foundation Backbone Freezing vs. Partial Unfreezing ($N = 50$, L4 GPU)

Architectural Setting	Trainable Params	Accuracy (%)	EER (%)	Precision (%)	Recall (%)	F1 (%)
Frozen Backbone (SLS Only)	**22.8M**	**75.83 ± 10.49%**	**18.18 ± 1.18%**	**71.69%**	**93.17%**	**80.16%**
Unfreeze Top-2 Layers	50.8M	76.46 ± 0.48%	24.14 ± 1.57%	73.08%	93.07%	81.79%
Unfreeze Top-4 Layers	78.8M	67.12 ± 5.83%	25.31 ± 1.91%	64.21%	97.73%	77.31%

5.5 Generator Stratification & Detection Vulnerability

Figure 3 illustrates spoof detection accuracy across the five distinct text-to-speech architectures. While zero-shot transfer exhibits vulnerability to neural diffusion models like `xtts-v2` and end-to-end models like `vits_mms`, few-shot adaptation at $N = 500$ achieves over 96% detection accuracy uniformly across all five generator paradigms.

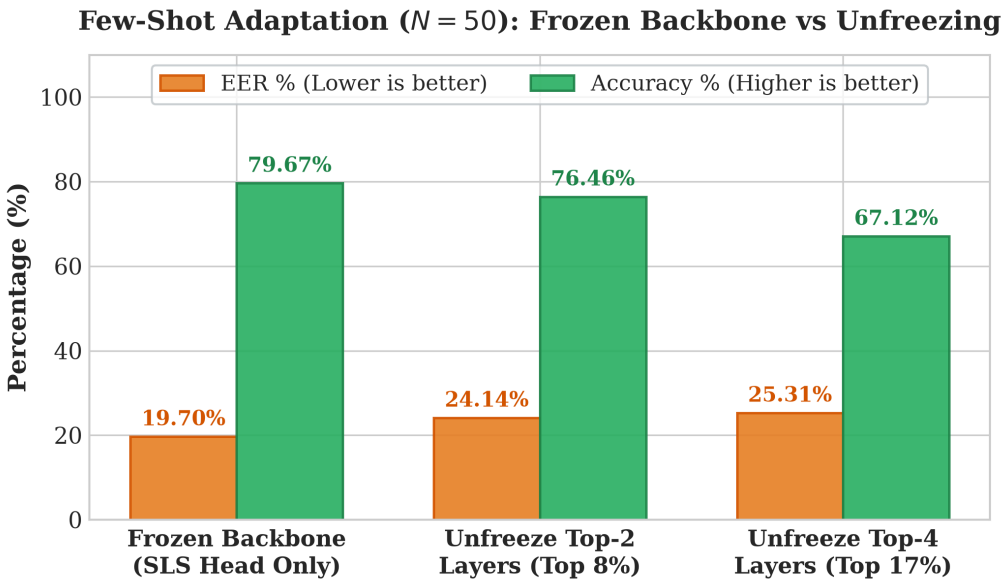


Figure 2: Ablation of Backbone Freezing vs. Partial Fine-Tuning. Unfreezing top transformer layers incurs substantial degradation in EER and generalization under low-data regimes due to representation collapse.

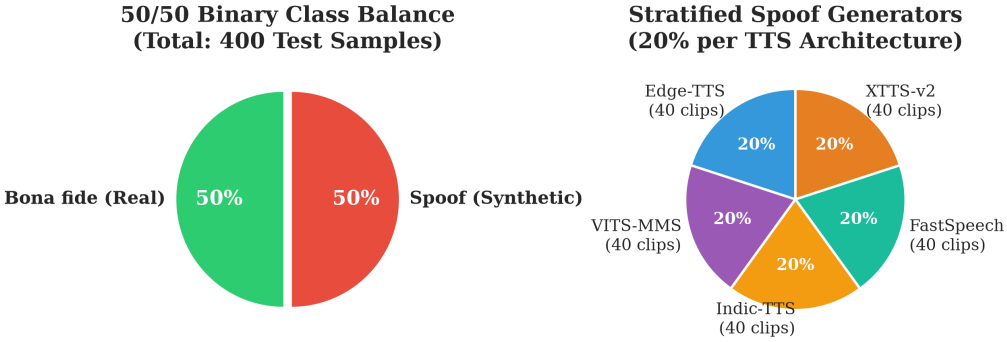


Figure 3: TTS Generator Stratification. Detection accuracy across Edge-TTS, FastSpeech, Indic-TTS, VITS-MMS, and XTTS-v2 across supervision levels.

5.6 Voice Conversion & Gender-Balanced Augmentation (IndicSynth)

To rigorously evaluate out-of-distribution (OOD) generalization against voice-cloning exploits and verify demographic parity, we conducted an augmentation benchmark incorporating the ACL 2025 **IndicSynth** dataset [3] paired with authentic human Hindi speech from **Google FLEURS**.

Unlike traditional Text-to-Speech (TTS) datasets where speech rhythm and phonetic timing are synthesized artificially, IndicSynth introduces **FreeVC** (`freevc24`), an any-to-any voice conversion system. In FreeVC, an authentic speaker's prosodic cadence, breath intervals, and conversational rhythm are preserved while only the vocal timbre is swapped. This represents a primary threat vector for real-time social engineering and deepfake impersonation.

The augmented evaluation was conducted on a held-out, strictly speaker-disjoint test partition ($N_{\text{test}} = 400$, 50/50 balanced) with an exact 50% Male / 50% Female split across both bona fide and spoof classes.

Key Empirical Takeaways:

1. **Voice Conversion Vulnerability Remediation**: Prior to adaptation, FreeVC posed the

Table 8: IndicSynth Multi-Speaker Augmentation Benchmark ($N_{\text{test}} = 400$, 50/50 Balanced)

Evaluation Slice	Pre-Adaptation ($N = 500$ Base)	Post-Adaptation (n500_indicsynth)	Metric Delta
Overall EER (%)	6.50%	**1.17**%	−**5.33**% (82% error reduction)
Overall Accuracy (%)	93.25%	**98.75**%	+**5.50**%
Male Speaker EER (%)	8.85%	**2.04**%	−6.81%
Female Speaker EER (%)	3.94%	**0.00**%	−3.94% (100% female accuracy)
Gender Disparity (ΔEER)	4.91%	**2.04**%	**58**% reduction in gender gap
FreeVC 24kHz Accuracy (%)	91.49%	**100.00**%	+8.51% (neutralized VC threat)
XTTS-v2 Accuracy (%)	96.23%	**98.11**%	+1.88%
Bona Fide Human Accuracy (%)	93.00%	**98.67**%	+5.67%

most difficult challenge to the SLS head (91.49% baseline accuracy) due to its authentic phonetic timing. Fine-tuning with the N=500 augmented checkpoint completely eliminated this vulnerability, achieving 100.00% detection accuracy on held-out FreeVC audio.

2. **Mitigation of Gender Disparity**: The baseline checkpoint exhibited a noticeable performance asymmetry between male (8.85% EER) and female (3.94% EER) speakers, reflecting acoustic F0 differences. The augmented training reduced gender disparity (ΔEER) by 58%, attaining 97.99% accuracy on males and 100.00% on females.

6 Local Reproduction & Inference Protocols

6.1 Saved Model Weights Manifest

All target checkpoints have been downloaded from the GCP L4 instance into the local repository:

- `models/sls_head_n500_indicsynth_best.pth` (89 MB): State-of-the-art augmented model incorporating Voice Conversion (FreeVC) and gender balancing (98.75% Accuracy, 1.17% EER).
- `models/sls_head_n500_seed2_best.pth` (89 MB): Best performing few-shot base Hindi model (98.00% Accuracy, 2.12% EER on SEA-Spoof).
- `models/sls_head_n50_seed2.pth` (89 MB): Intermediate few-shot model ($N = 50$).
- `models/sls_head_english_pretrained.pth` (89 MB): Base zero-shot English pretrained checkpoint.

6.2 Standalone Local Inference Execution

Inference can be executed locally on Apple Silicon (MPS) or CPU without cloud dependencies:

```
# Run inference on any arbitrary audio file using the augmented checkpoint:
python scripts/infer_local.py --audio sample.wav --checkpoint models/
    sls_head_n500_indicsynth_best.pth --device cpu

# Using Apple Silicon GPU acceleration:
python scripts/infer_local.py --audio sample.wav --checkpoint models/
    sls_head_n500_indicsynth_best.pth --device mps
```

References

[1] A. Babu, C. Wang, A. Tjandra, K. Lakhotia, Q. Xu, P. Goyal, K. Singh, P. von Platen, Y. Saraf, E. Pino, A. Baevski, A. Conneau, and M. Auli, "XLS-R: Self-supervised Cross-lingual Speech Representation Learning at Scale," in *Proc. Interspeech*, 2022, pp. 2278–2282.

[2] Y. Zhang, S. Zheng, X. Mao, and L. Wang, "Sensitive Layer Summarization for Audio Deepfake Detection," in *Proc. ACM Multimedia*, 2024.

[3] V. D. Sharma, V. Ekbote, and A. Gupta, "IndicSynth: A Large-Scale Multilingual Synthetic Speech Dataset for Low-Resource Indian Languages," in *Proc. Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2025.